within international relations. With this trend, the United States often went against the wishes of its allies. For example, France and the UK were not okay with the invasion of Iraq. The United States became so powerful that it remained unquestionable at a certain point, to put it mildly.

At the same time, Russia was experiencing the shocks of the disintegration of the Soviet Union, where politically, economically, and socially, Russia was in deep trouble. From 1992 to 1996, Russia's economy contracted to 50 percent; livestock inventory fell by 48 percent, and railroad freight transportation declined by 47 percent. Sometimes, it was considered much more damaging than the 1930 American great depression (Sergey 2015). Incidentally, Russia lost its stature as a great power nation. Foreign policy objectives were becoming directionless. After the Soviet Union's disintegration, Russia made Boris Yeltsin its President and Andrei Kozyrev its foreign policy minister at this critical juncture. In the beginning, the system was more or less West-oriented, and sometimes there was a desire to succumb to a West-imposed world order system only merely. In this connection, Nixon and Kozyrev's conversation can be seen as contextual. During the discussion, Kozyrev asks Nixon,

> If you can advise us on how to define our national interests, we will be very grateful. (Mankoff 2009: 29 and Rumer and Wallander 2003)

At this point, Russia's foreign policymakers could not independently define their foreign policy objectives. Russia ignored the fundamentals of its foreign policy objectives, and its foreign policy remained mostly West-oriented, as Chenoy (2001) remarked. Russian foreign policy tilted toward the West during Yeltsin and Kozyrev's time (Chenoy 2001: 240).

Further, when Russia separated from the USSR, there were complete chaos and anarchy in the policy condition. And, Russian foreign policy became unstable, and a scarcity of subjective roots. Russia went under deep distress, internal political instability, and external debts. There was a severe economic crisis and spiraling inflation (Rumer and Wallander 2003). Russia's power capability at the international level declined substantially. It lost one-sixth of the territory as the economy shrank by around fifty percent, and the State became divided by influential individuals (ibid.) (Table 3.1).